

# Hidden London Pubs & Bars

12 Secret Pubs · 3 Hours · Holborn to Southwark

Skip the tourist trap pubs and drink where Dickens, Churchill and Shakespeare actually drank. These 12 hidden taverns are London's greatest kept secret.

YOU SAVE: £167 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

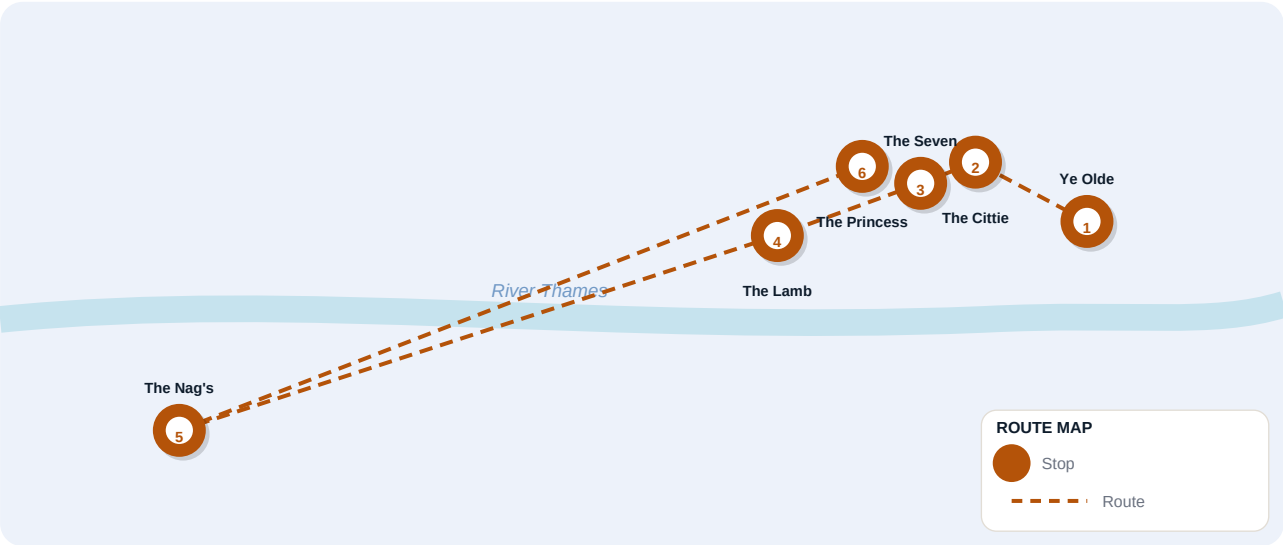
Retail price of this guide  
**£12.99**

Equivalent guided tours  
**£180**

YOUR SAVING  
**£167**

| ROUTE INFO   |                                                                |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Start      | Ye Olde Cheshire Cheese (Fleet Street)                         |
| ■ End        | The Princess Louise (Holborn)                                  |
| ■ Duration   | 3 Hours                                                        |
| ■ Transport  | From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops |
| ■ Total Cost | Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs    |

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location

|                       |                                                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ <b>Saving</b>       | Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person            |
| ■ <b>Offline map</b>  | Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel                       |
| ■ <b>Transport</b>    | Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10) |
| ■ <b>Members only</b> | This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers                  |

# ■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — HIDDEN LONDON PUBS & BARS

Follow stops 1→6 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

## Ye Olde Cheshire Cheese

Fleet Street · Mon–Sat 11am–11pm, Sun 12–6pm

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

Rebuilt in 1667 after the Great Fire. Dickens, Tennyson, Voltaire and Teddy Roosevelt all drank here. Order a real ale and find the tiny snugs downstairs — each one has its own fireplace.

■ SAVING

Tour guides charge £25pp for a pub walk — this costs £0

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Chancery Lane tube (6 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1 — included in daily cap

DO THIS:

- ✓ Find the parrot that's been here since 1926
- ✓ Order the house porter ale
- ✓ Count the low beams — it's older than the USA

■ Best: Weekday lunchtime — quiet, atmospheric

AVOID:

Friday evenings — City workers pack it out

★★★★★

free entry

2

## The Cittie of Yorke

Holborn · Mon–Sat 11:30am–11pm

■ 5 min walk

HIDDEN TIP

The longest pub bar in Britain — 23 metres of solid mahogany. The huge triangular wine vats above the bar are original 17th century. Utterly theatrical and almost empty mid-week.

■ SAVING

Free to enter vs £18 pub crawl tours

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Chancery Lane (3 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Sit in one of the private wooden cubicles
- ✓ Try the house bitter
- ✓ Look at the wine vats — they're 400 years old

■ Best: Mid-week afternoon

AVOID:

After 6pm when lawyers from Gray's Inn arrive

★★★★★

free entry

3



## The Seven Stars

Lincoln's Inn Fields · Mon–Fri 11am–11pm, Sat–Sun 12–8pm

■ 8 min walk

### HIDDEN TIP

Survived the Great Fire of 1667 — one of the few pubs in London that didn't burn. The landlady's cat has a barrister's wig. Impossibly small, utterly charming.

#### ■ SAVING

Hidden gem — no entry fees ever

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Holborn (5 min walk)

Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Meet the wig-wearing cat
- ✓ Order the scotch egg — legendary
- ✓ Try the daily hand-pulled guest ale
- Best: Lunch on a weekday

#### AVOID:

Post-court rushes around 4–5pm

★★★★★

free entry

4



## The Lamb & Flag

Covent Garden · Mon–Thu 11am–11pm, Fri–Sat 11am–midnight, Sun 12–10:30pm

■ 12 min walk

### HIDDEN TIP

The oldest pub in Covent Garden (1772). The poet Dryden was beaten up by hired thugs in the alley outside in 1679. Now the alley is the best drinking spot — look for the brass plaque.

#### ■ SAVING

Free entry vs £22 Covent Garden pub tour

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Covent Garden (3 min walk)

Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Find Dryden's plaque in the alley
- ✓ Order the Oxford Blue ale
- ✓ Stand in the original timber frame snug
- Best: Early evening before theatre crowds

#### AVOID:

Saturday evenings

★★★★■

free entry

5



# The Nag's Head

Belgravia · Mon–Sat 11am–11pm, Sun 12–10:30pm

■ 20 min or tube

## HIDDEN TIP

No music, no fruit machines, no mobile phones (enforced). London's last truly old-school pub. The landlord will confiscate your phone. No cash machines outside — bring cash.

### ■ SAVING

An experience money literally cannot buy elsewhere

### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Knightsbridge (8 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

## DO THIS:

- ✓ Experience a smartphone-free pub
- ✓ Try the Adnams Bitter on draught
- ✓ Admire the extraordinary collection of junk on the walls
- Best: Sunday afternoon — quiet and perfect

## AVOID:

Trying to pay by card — cash only

★★★★★

free entry

6



# The Princess Louise

Holborn · Mon–Sat 11am–11pm, Sun 12–10:30pm

■ 25 min or tube

## HIDDEN TIP

The most spectacular Victorian pub interior in London. Etched glass, faience tiles, a gilded ceiling and separate private booths. Grade II listed — the interior is a protected national treasure.

### ■ SAVING

Under £3 pints in central London = save £3-5 per drink vs nearby bars

### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Holborn (3 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

## DO THIS:

- ✓ Count the different types of Victorian tile
- ✓ Get a private booth at the back
- ✓ Try the Sam Smith's ales — cheapest pints in central London (unde...)
- Best: Midday on a weekday when light comes through the etched glas

## AVOID:

After 5pm — packed with office workers

★★★★★

free entry

## QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

| # | Name                      | Area             | Walk           | Cost       | Tube               | Rating |
|---|---------------------------|------------------|----------------|------------|--------------------|--------|
| 1 | Ye Olde Cheshire Chees... | Fleet Street     | Start here     | free entry | Chancery Lane tube | ★★★★★  |
| 2 | The Citty of Yorke        | Holborn          | 5 min walk     | free entry | Chancery Lane (3 m | ★★★★★  |
| 3 | The Seven Stars           | Lincoln's Inn Fi | 8 min walk     | free entry | Holborn (5 min wal | ★★★★★  |
| 4 | The Lamb & Flag           | Covent Garden    | 12 min walk    | free entry | Covent Garden (3 m | ★★★★■  |
| 5 | The Nag's Head            | Belgravia        | 20 min or tube | free entry | Knightsbridge (8 m | ★★★★★  |
| 6 | The Princess Louise       | Holborn          | 25 min or tube | free entry | Holborn (3 min wal | ★★★★★  |

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